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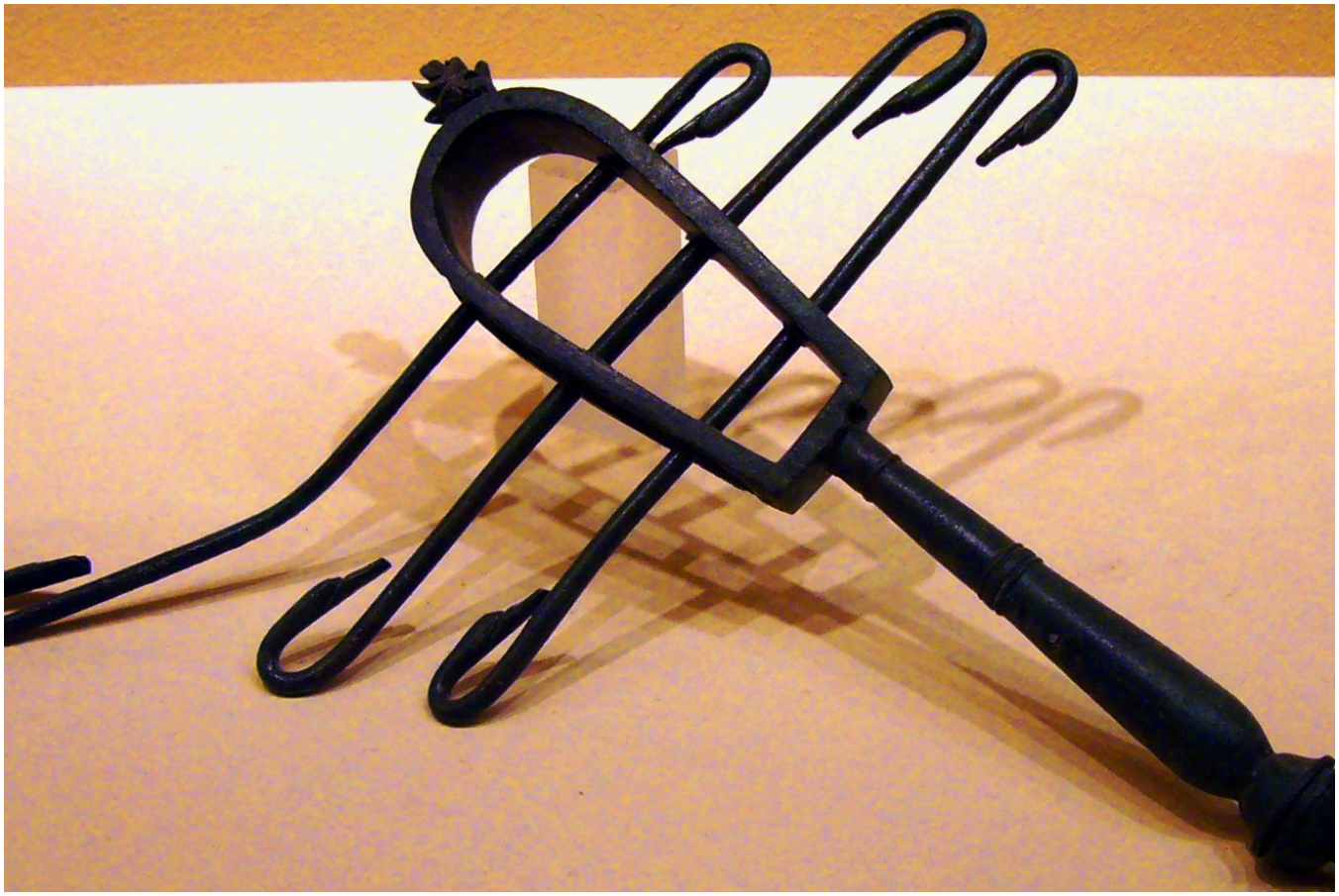
Sistrum

7.4.1 Sistrum

Reference:

Hebrew שָׁלִישׁ (shalish) 1SA 18:6

Description:



Drawing of a sistrum, a type of musical rattle (© Lalupa - Wikimedia Commons)The sistrum consisted of a frame carrying short wires on which small metal rings were threaded.

Usage:

The sistrum was shaken, making a rattling or tinkling sound. Its use accompanied singing and dancing.

Translation:

The Hebrew word *shalish* meaning “sistrum” appears only in 1SA 18:6. Its exact meaning is uncertain. Other possible meanings are “triangle,” “three-stringed lute,” “triangular harp,” and “triangular hand drum.”